Funding Renewable Energy

Kaku Nakhate, *57*
President and Country Head (India), Bank of America

ACCOMPLISHMENT
Under her, Bank of America facilitated a large foreign investment in the Indian renewable energy sector

FOR SEVERAL YEARS NOW, Kaku Nakhate has made Bank of America (BoA) the ultimate destination for foreign investors interested in the Indian market—shepherding, for example, Facebook's $5.7-billion investment in Reliance Jio in 2020. Similarly, it has provided a guiding hand to Indian start-ups. But the president and India country head of Bank of America is the proudest when securing deals that could significantly contribute to India's net zero targets. BofA Securities, Bank of America's investment banking division, recently advised Gentari, the renewable energy arm of Malaysian energy giant PETRONAS, on their $1.5 billion investment in AM Green, the Indian green hydrogen/ammonia platform that aims to produce 5 million tonnes of green ammonia annually by 2030.

"It is a source of pride for us and our country. In the renewable sector, this marks our 11th deal, and we now control 70 per cent of the market share," says Kaku. In 2021, BoA executed a benchmark deal with TPG Rise Climate's $1 billion investment in Tata Motors for its electric vehicles business.

Kaku is advancing the bank's mission to integrate sustainability not only into investment banking but also into corporate banking and capital markets. The bank leads the market in providing sustainability-linked loans (SLL), offering borrowers funds at lower interest rates if they meet their ESG (environment, social, and governance) targets. Thus, L&T was issued a $150 million SLL with pre-determined targets related to the reduction of greenhouse gas emissions. Under Kaku's leadership, India contributes 17-18 per cent of the bank's net profits. Throughout her stellar career, her mother's advice served as a beacon: "Measure yourself against yourself and strive to do better every single day."

Kaku's commitment towards a greener planet is linked to her belief in giving back to the community, a lesson she learned from her parents. It's a value system that led her to donate her first paycheck to an NGO working for the blind. Under her, BoA is sponsoring the children's museum at Mumbai's Chhatrapati Shivaji Maharaj Vastu Sangrahalaya. "We are working towards offering workshops to give children access to cultural learning," she says. The bank has supported the restoration of a priceless manuscript of the *Anvar-I Suhayli*, the 15th-century Persian translation of the *Kalilah-wah-Dimnah*, the Arabic version of the *Panchatantra*. ■

–Sonal Khetarpal

STAND AND DELIVER

"Do not be afraid to claim your success, to stand up for yourself, take risks and to follow your dream"

NATURE WATCH Loves flowers and takes pictures of them. "They give me happiness and hope"



MILIND SHELTE